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shuttle on test
run in Abu Dhabi**



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BUSINESS | P5

**UAE signs trade
deals with Malaysia,
New Zealand**

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**PEOPLE WITH
CHRONIC ILLNESSES
NEED SUPPORT**

Dr. Ahmed Shatila, Neurology Consultant at Sheikh Shakhboub Medical City (SSMC), explains

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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT HONOURS ZAYED SUSTAINABILITY AWARD WINNERS

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan presents the 2025 Zayed Sustainability Prize for Middle East & Northern Africa Global High Schools, to a representative from Merryland International School (UAE), during Abu Dhabi Sustainability Week (ADSW 2025), at Abu Dhabi National Exhibition Centre (ADNEC), yesterday. **SEE ALSO P4**

Pakistanis travelling to Gulf must show legitimate reason

Measure part of crackdown on 'dubious passengers'

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

Pakistanis travelling to UAE and other GCC countries are now required to provide supporting documents to justify their travel plans.

Pakistan's Federal Minister for Commerce Jam Kamal Khan explained in Dubai how Pakistan's immigration and border control measures are evolving, focusing on efforts to stop the travel of individuals who do not have proper documentation or legitimate travel purposes, including

suspected beggars who have been a growing concern particularly in UAE and Saudi Arabia.

Restrictions

"The Pakistan government is also taking stronger action to stop 'dubious passengers' and those attempting to travel without the necessary resources or clear intent. We are closely monitoring and preventing individuals, including suspected beggars, from leaving the country without the appropriate documents

These steps are part of Pakistan's strategy to ensure that travellers are not exploited by human traffickers.

and supporting information," Kamal Khan added.

Speaking at an event hosted by the Pakistan Business Council in Dubai, Kamal Khan focused on critical issues affecting Pakistan-UAE trade relations, travel restrictions, and efforts to stop beggars from travelling abroad.

These steps, he noted, are part of Pakistan's broader strategy to ensure that travellers are prepared for their journeys and not exploited by human traffickers or sent to foreign countries without legitimate employment opportunities.

The government has put in place additional scrutiny at airports to ensure that everyone travelling has a clear, documented purpose for their visit.

SEE ALSO P2

Kerala rolls out ambitious plan to build city for non-resident Keralites

NRK City offers attractive schemes to investors

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Kerala has outlined plans to create a dedicated city for non-resident Keralites (NRKs)—NRK City—coupled with significant tax incentives to attract over \$10 billion in investments, particularly from the Gulf region, a senior state Minister told *Gulf*

News. Minister for Industries, Law and Coir P Rajeev hopes for the investments to have a 100 per cent conversion rate.

NRK City, currently in the planning and architectural design phase, aims to channel the substantial remittances sent by Keralites abroad into productive avenues that generate employment and foster economic growth rather than just purchasing large houses or land, explained Rajeev.

The city will offer special schemes for NRK investors, including reduced premiums and moratoriums on invest-

ments, to make it an attractive proposition for those looking to contribute to Kerala's economy.

The minister is in the UAE to hard-sell Kerala's investment opportunities to the Gulf diaspora ahead of its ambitious 'Invest Kerala Global Summit' in mid-February. Over 200 business leaders are expected to participate.

He said, "We are ready to reimburse 100 per cent of state goods and services tax (GST) component for capital investment and capital incentives of INR 10 crores (Rs100 million)."

SEE ALSO P5

ENTERTAINMENT

Malayalam film Marco enters Rs1-billion club global box office | P15



WORLD

From AI students to cave dwellers, Kumbh Mela has it all | P11

UAE launches MBZ-SAT aboard SpaceX rocket

REGION'S MOST ADVANCED COMMERCIAL EARTH OBSERVATION SATELLITE MARKS NEW CHAPTER IN COUNTRY'S SPACE HISTORY

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE yesterday opened a new chapter in its space history by launching three satellites including the region's most advanced commercial Earth observation satellite named in honour of the country's President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, from the US.

A project of the Mohammad Bin Rashid Space Centre (MBRSC), the Emirati-made MBZ-SAT was launched along with two other CubeSats made by university students in the country — HCT-SAT 1, developed by students and faculty of the Higher Colleges of Technology under the guidance of MBRSC engineers and Al Ain Sat-1 developed by the National Space Science and Technology Centre at the UAE University in collaboration with multiple partners.

The three satellites were launched into space on board a Falcon 9 rocket of Elon Musk's SpaceX from Space Launch Complex 4E (SLC-4E) at the Vandenberg Space Force Base in California.

Another milestone

The rocket launch, part of SpaceX Transporter-12 ride-share mission with 131 payloads, was scheduled with a 27-minute window opening at 10.49pm in the UAE. The lift-off took place at 11.09pm, marking another milestone in the UAE's



MBRSC

Falcon 9 rocket carrying three UAE-made satellites lifts off yesterday from the Space Launch Complex 4E at the Vandenberg Space Force Base in California.

ambitious space programme and reinforcing the nation's reputation as a global leader in advanced space technologies and sustainable innovation.

Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, grandson of His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum,

Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, who graduated from the Royal Military Academy Sandhurst in the UK last month, witnessed the launch from a brand new Mission Control Centre of MBRSC that became operational with the historic launch.

SEE ALSO P3

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